Caregiver Call Off Playbook

Nursing Styles · one page summary

What it does

Gives the office and on-call staff one shared way to handle a caregiver call-off, fill the open shift fast, and keep clients and families informed, day or night. The goal: no client is ever left without care and without notice.

The main steps

1. **Take the call-off.** Confirm the caregiver, the visit, and a reason category (never health details). Read it back before hanging up.
2. **Find every affected visit** in AxisCare for the next 72 hours and check each client's needs and preferences.
3. **Set priority.** Visits starting within 4 hours, or a caregiver leaving mid-shift, get handled first.
4. **Offer the shift** to qualified caregivers and confirm the replacement personally before changing AxisCare.
5. **Keep the family informed** and escalate to a manager if a visit is still open at set times.
6. **Log everything** and review call-off patterns weekly.

Ground rules

- People make every staffing decision. The after-hours phone assistant only takes the message and alerts on-call staff.
- Never send someone who is not qualified for the visit.
- Care questions go to the On-Call Nurse or Director of Nursing.

What you need to decide

- Who is on the after-hours on-call list, and in what order.
- When overtime or a shift bonus can be offered, and who approves it.
- Escalation times for a visit that is still unfilled.